

Canon PIXMA MP830

The Canon PIXMA MP830 supports print, scan, fax and copy functions. Like the MP530, this one is capable of printing photos. Its five-cartridge printing aims at enabling printing photos and images with life-like colours at a resolution of 9600 x 2100 dpi. In addition to PictBridge, the MP830 has an inbuilt card reader that supports a variety of formats: CompactFlash, Micro Drive, SD, MMC, MS, MS Pro, MS Duo, MS Pro Duo and XD. A photo can be previewed on the 6.3 cm colour LCD screen that swivels to suit your viewing angle. The CD/DVD printing feature lets you label the CDs and DVDs that you burn.

The 33.6 Kbps modem can receive and store up to 250 pages of fax while you are not near the unit. The fax operates without the necessity to connect to a PC. You can store up to 100 fax numbers in the memory and eight one-touch-dial numbers. The automatic document feeder (ADF) can automatically scan both sides of the page without the need for intervention. Broadcast, delayed, and scheduled faxes are the other features available.

The scanner unit of the MFD is a 48-bit CCD, and can scan at 2400 x 4800 dpi. The ADF can hold 35 sheets of paper. The copier unit can scan up to 99 copies of a document, and can also print the copy with a zoom of 25 to 400 per cent.

As expected, the MP830 printed at blistering speeds. The first black and white text document printed in five seconds flat! Similarly, the photo printed in just a little over two minutes. Scanning was also very fast, and the full colour photo was scanned in a mere 29 seconds. The overall scan quality was good, and the print quality was amazing even in Draft mode. Sadly, the Canon PIXMA MP830 is priced very high: Rs 26,999.

+ Excellent Speed and Quality, Duplex ADF

- None

Price: Rs. 26,999



is acceptable when seen from a distance, and just about passable when viewed closely. Colour copying was bad on both the P6250 and the 215C.

Next up was the Epson CX4700 at Rs 8,999. It took 22 seconds in Text mode, there were no visible smudges or gaps in print, but the print looked dull, as if not enough ink had been deposited on the paper. Copying took 38 seconds for black and white and 53 seconds for colour. The photo printout could have been brighter and more vivid.

The most expensive MFD in this category, the HP Officejet 5610 All-in-One, is just a rupee short of the 10,000 mark. Through priced similarly, there is some difference in the print quality of the CX4700 and the 5610, with the 5610 being the better of the two. In fact, it can boast of some of the best print qualities in this segment. In the copy test, however, the 5610 was disappointing, given its good print quality and also its positioning in this price segment.

Build Quality And Ease Of Use

The Canon MP150 and the Epson CX4700 do not have a zoom function except for the "Fit to Page" feature. This is disappointing; all the other MFDs provide for a 25 to 400 per cent reduction or enlargement. The number of copies that can be

taken in a single go is only nine, while the others offer 99. (The HP 5610 offers 100.) Only the HP 5610 offers sheet feed for scanning, while all the others make do with a flatbed. The Epson CX4700 has only a minimal display, which shows the number of copies set.

A fax function with a dialpad is provided by the HP 5610 and the Brother 215C. This is complemented by a dedicated fax button apart from the copy and scan buttons. The other MFDs have buttons for scanning and copying (separately for black and colour).

The HP 5610 had flimsy paper trays that just about hold on to the unit: a gentle push and off comes the tray. The CX4700's scanner cover can be simply lifted off its body—we wonder why it could not be fastened somewhere. As far as the overall build quality goes, the Epson CX4700 is compact and also more rugged.

Our Conclusion

If we were to consider performance alone, the Canon MP150 would have been the clear winner due to its superb print quality and speed. But life isn't that simple for MFDs—there is the price factor and feature set to consider. The HP 5610 looks good on the spec sheets and performs just as well. With good printing quality, the *Digit Best Buy Gold* goes to the HP 5610. At Rs 4,490, the Brother 115C is second on the charts offering value for money, thus earning the *Digit Best Buy Silver* award.

Coming close to second place are the Lexmark P6250 and the Brother MFC-215C. Both are priced the same, and the P6250 scores in performance while the 215C makes up in the features. If there were to be a Bronze award, these two would tie for it.

FOR PROFESSIONAL USE: PHOTO MFDs ABOVE RS 10,000

The target market for this segment is businesses looking for bulk printing and network printing. These MFDs are heavy-duty machines with extensive features. Naturally, price is of the least importance in this category, and it goes without saying that the most expensive inkjet MFDs land up in this category.

Performance

Opening this segment is the Brother MFC-410CN and the Canon PIXMA MP450 at Rs 10,490 and Rs 10,995 respectively. The 410CN, like other Brother MFDs, shows gaps in monochrome print, which appear as lines under the Normal setting. The colour print loses out on detailing, which can only be regained at the Best quality setting. The MP450 takes a blistering eight seconds for a Draft print and nine for a Normal, with the numbers for the 410CN being 20 and 29 seconds.

Copying is certainly not a feature the Brother 410CN can brag about—at least in black and white mode; the quality is so bad, it looks like someone took a bad photograph of your document and then took a bad printout of the photo! In colour mode, the text quality is a lot better, but the graphics seem to contain less of every colour—essentially the "washed out" effect. The MP450's copy appears almost as good



Brother MFC-5840CN

Contact Sheet

Inkjet MFD

Brand	Company	Phone	E-Mail	Website
Brother	Godrej & Boyce Mfg Co Ltd	022-55961609	nad@godrej.com	www.brother.com
Canon	Canon India Pvt Ltd	0124-516 0000	info@canon.co.in	www.canon.co.in
Epson	Epson India Pvt Ltd	080-30515000	rajeshp@eid.epson.co.in	www.epson.co.in
HP	Hewlett-Packard India Sales Pvt Ltd	0124-2566111	ashwini-k.aggarwal@hp.com	www.hp.co.in
Lexmark	Lexmark International India Pvt Ltd	022-26057744	sandeepk@lexmark.com	www.lexmark.co.in